```
  var username = components[0];
  var password = components[1];

  if (!username.matches(USERNAME_PATTERN)) {
    throw new IllegalArgumentException("invalid username");
  }

  var hash = database.findOptional(String.class,
      "SELECT pw_hash FROM users WHERE user_id = ?",
username);

  if (hash.isPresent() &&     #D
      SCryptUtil.check(password, hash.get())) {    #D
    request.attribute("subject", username);
  }
}
```

#A Check to see if there is an HTTP Basic Authorization header.
#B Decode the credentials using Base64 and UTF-8.
#C Split the credentials into username and password.
#D If the user exists, then use the Scrypt library to check the password.

We can wire this into the Main class as a filter in front of all API calls. Open the Main.java file in your text editor again, and add the following line to the main method underneath where you created the `userController` object:

```
    before(userController::authenticate);
```

You can now update your API methods to check that the authenticated user matches any claimed identity in the